



Codex Opportunity Fit Exercise Guide

Purpose

Use this guide to complete the recommended exercise in the Codex Opportunity Fit course.

This guide is not a worksheet. You do not need to fill it in, submit it, or upload anything for review.

Instead, use it as a reference while you make your own notes, draft a seller-ready recommendation, and ask GPT to critique your reasoning.

Part A. Context: Read the customer information

A retail technology company is modernizing several legacy services that support order management, inventory updates, and customer notifications.

Engineering leadership says modernization has been slower than expected, even though the company increased engineering headcount last year.

The VP of Engineering says teams are “busy but not moving work through fast enough.”

Product leadership says customer-facing roadmap items have slipped twice because engineering teams are spending more time than expected on maintenance and review.

Several engineering managers report similar patterns:

- Pull request reviews for older services often wait for a small group of senior engineers.
- Newer engineers spend significant time asking for help understanding legacy code paths.
- Late-stage defects create rework before release.
- Documentation is inconsistent across teams.
- Platform engineering is trying to standardize developer workflows, but the current initiative is still broad.
- Security wants to understand how AI-assisted work would be reviewed and monitored before approving any evaluation.

The customer has a clear business concern: modernization delays are affecting roadmap execution and customer-facing improvements.

However, the team has not yet agreed on a specific workflow to evaluate first.

Part B. Instructions: How to complete the exercise

Use your own document, notes app, notebook, or ChatGPT conversation to capture notes. You do not need to use a specific template.

Follow these steps:

1. Read the customer context once for the overall story.
2. Read it again and make notes about the evidence.
3. Use the analysis guide to assess opportunity fit.

4. Decide whether the opportunity should progress, continue discovery, pause, or be disqualified.
5. Draft a short seller-ready recommendation.
6. Paste your notes and draft into GPT using the critique prompt.
7. Revise your recommendation based on the critique.
8. Optionally compare your reasoning with the example at the end of this guide.

Your notes do not need to be polished. They only need to capture enough evidence for you to draft and improve your recommendation.

Part C. Analysis guide: Use the Codex Opportunity Fit Lens

Use these five checks to guide your notes.

1. Recurring pain

Look for whether the pain appears recurring or isolated.

In this case, possible evidence may include:

- Review delays.
- Legacy knowledge gaps.
- Testing or defect rework.
- Modernization complexity.
- Documentation inconsistency.
- Broad platform workflow standardization efforts.

Ask yourself:

- Where does work appear to slow down?
- Does the case suggest the issue appears across multiple teams, services, or delivery cycles?
- Is this a one-time complaint, or a repeated operating pattern?
- What evidence supports that conclusion?

2. Business impact

Look for the business consequence of the workflow friction.

In this case, possible evidence may include:

- Roadmap slippage.
- Delayed customer-facing improvements.
- Slower modernization.
- Engineering capacity absorbed by maintenance and review.

Ask yourself:

- Why does the workflow friction matter to the business?
- What customer, product, roadmap, quality, cost, or capacity outcome is affected?
- What business impact still needs to be clarified?

3. Stakeholder ownership

Identify which stakeholders are involved and what each contributes to qualification.

Consider:

- VP of Engineering: delivery pressure and leadership urgency.
- Product leadership: roadmap and customer impact.
- Engineering managers: workflow reality.
- Platform engineering: developer workflow improvement.
- Security: readiness and oversight concerns.

Ask yourself:

- Who appears to care about the problem?
- Who may own improvement?
- Which stakeholder relationship is promising but still unclear?

4. Readiness

Assess whether the customer appears ready to evaluate a better way of working.

Look for whether the customer can:

- Describe the current workflow.
- Support a concrete evaluation task with accessible context and tools.
- Involve the right stakeholders.
- Explain how AI-assisted work would be reviewed or validated.
- Connect the evaluation to a business or engineering outcome.

Ask yourself:

- What readiness signals are strong?
- What readiness signals are missing?
- What would need to be true before this opportunity could progress confidently?

5. Repeatable workflow

Identify the specific software delivery workflow behind the broad problem label, then translate it into a concrete evaluation task.

Avoid stopping at labels such as “developer productivity,” “modernization,” or “coordination.” Look for a bounded software engineering task, the context and tools it requires, the target artifact or environment, and the checks that would verify the result.

Possible task candidates may include:

- Reviewing a defined pull request or set of changes against agreed guidance.
- Investigating a bounded CI or test failure using available repository and test context.
- Updating tests for a specified code path or service.
- Updating documentation for a defined code change.
- Preparing a review-ready change for a defined legacy service.

Ask yourself:

- What concrete task should be evaluated first?
- What context and tools does the task require, and are they accessible?
- What artifact or environment is in scope?
- What checks and human review will verify the result?

Oversight or review concerns

The case includes a security stakeholder who wants to understand how AI-assisted work would be reviewed and monitored before approving an evaluation.

Treat this as part of readiness and progression judgment.

Ask yourself:

- Is this a blocker, a readiness gap, or a follow-up item?
- Who should help address it?
- What level of detail is appropriate for this seller-level recommendation?

You do not need to resolve the concern. You only need to identify whether it affects readiness or requires specialist follow-up.

Progression risks

Look for what could slow or block the opportunity.

Possible risks include:

- The customer has not defined a concrete task to evaluate.
- Required context, tools, or access are unclear.
- The target artifact or environment is not defined.
- Verification criteria are unclear.
- Review, monitoring, or governance questions need routing.
- The business impact is visible, but the affected roadmap commitments need more detail.

Ask yourself:

- What is the biggest risk to progressing too quickly?
- What evidence would reduce that risk?
- What should the seller clarify next?

Part D. Decision guide: Choose a progression decision

Choose one recommendation.

Decision	Use this when...
Progress	The evidence shows recurring workflow pain, visible business impact, credible ownership, and a concrete task with accessible context and tools, a clear target, and verification criteria.
Continue discovery	The pain appears real, but business impact, ownership, stakeholder alignment, workflow clarity, task viability, or readiness is not yet clear enough to progress confidently.
Pause	Interest exists, but operational need, urgency, or readiness for workflow change is weak.
Disqualify	The problem is not connected to meaningful software delivery improvement, or there is no meaningful pain, owner, urgency, business impact, repeatable workflow, or concrete, verifiable task.

For this case, avoid choosing based on one strong signal alone. Look across the full evidence set.

A strong progression decision should answer:

- Is the pain real and recurring?
 - Is the business impact visible?
 - Is a credible owner engaged?
 - Is the workflow clear enough to define a concrete task?
 - Is readiness strong enough to proceed?
 - Are the required context and tools, target artifact or environment, and verification criteria clear enough?
 - What evidence is still missing?
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Part E. Recommendation guide: Draft your seller-ready recommendation

Use your notes to draft a concise recommendation. You can write it as short paragraphs or bullets.

Include these elements:

Opportunity summary

Briefly summarize the customer's software delivery problem.

Focus on the workflow issue and business consequence, not just the broad topic of modernization or developer productivity.

Qualification recommendation

State whether the opportunity should:

- Progress.
- Continue discovery.
- Pause.
- Be disqualified.

Likely direction

State whether the evidence points to:

- A deeper Codex discussion.
- Further discovery.

- Another OpenAI direction.
- Pause.
- Disqualification.

Briefly explain why this direction matches the evidence.

Qualification rationale

Explain your decision using the Codex Opportunity Fit Lens:

- Recurring pain.
- Business impact.
- Stakeholder ownership.
- Readiness.
- Repeatable workflow.
- Task viability.

Missing evidence or readiness risks

Identify what still needs to be confirmed before the opportunity can progress confidently.

Examples may include:

- No concrete evaluation task.
- Required context, tools, or access not confirmed.
- Target artifact or environment unclear.
- Verification criteria or human review unclear.
- Broad platform initiative without a specific task focus.

Recommended next steps

Suggest seller-level actions.

Examples may include:

- Confirm the priority workflow and the concrete task for evaluation.
- Align with the VP of Engineering and platform lead on ownership.
- Ask product leadership to clarify roadmap impact.
- Bring in the appropriate technical or security specialist if readiness questions become detailed.
- Define the target output or environment and the verification criteria.

Part F. GPT critique guide

After you draft your recommendation, use GPT to pressure-test it.

Paste your brief notes and draft recommendation into ChatGPT. Your notes can be rough. The goal is to give GPT enough context to critique your evidence, reasoning, and next-step logic.

Use the exercise case or anonymized notes only. Do not paste confidential customer information into ChatGPT unless your organization's approved data-handling guidance allows it.

Suggested prompt

Act as a sales leader reviewing an early-stage Codex opportunity fit recommendation.

I will provide my rough notes and draft recommendation. Critique my recommendation for clarity, evidence, and qualification discipline.

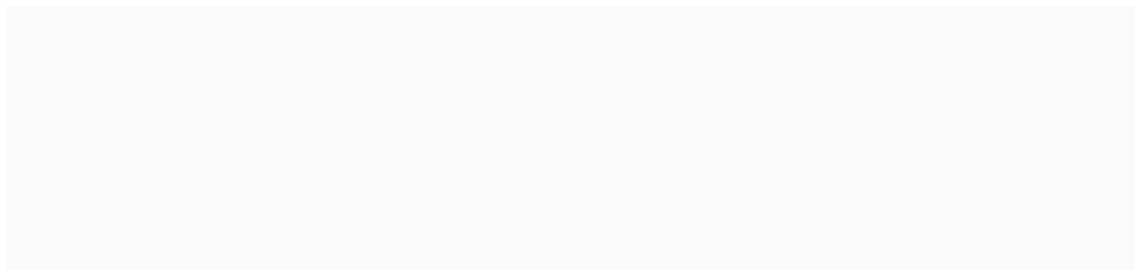
Look specifically at whether I have clearly identified:

- The repeatable workflow pain and the concrete evaluation task.
- The business impact.
- The stakeholder evidence.
- The readiness gaps.
- The Codex-fit rationale.
- Whether the required context and tools, target artifact or environment, and verification criteria are clear.
- Whether another OpenAI path or more discovery may be more appropriate.
- The next seller action.

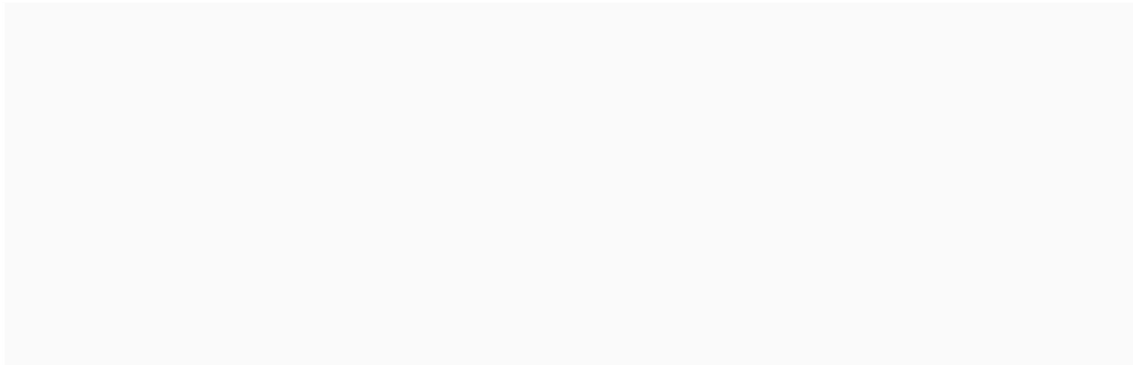
Do not rewrite the recommendation yet. First, identify what is strong, what is weak, what may be overstated, and what evidence is missing.

Keep the critique focused on qualification quality, commercial reasoning, and next seller action. Do not create a technical implementation plan.

Here are my notes:



Here is my draft recommendation:



Part G. Revision guide and final self-check

Use the critique to revise your recommendation.

Your final version should be balanced, evidence-based, and honest about what is not yet known.

Before you finalize, ask yourself:

- Did I identify the repeatable workflow and the concrete evaluation task, not just the broad problem?
- Did I explain why the pain matters to the business?
- Did I name the stakeholders and what each contributes?
- Did I identify readiness gaps honestly?
- Did I identify the required context and tools, target artifact or environment, and verification criteria?
- Did I recommend a next step that matches the evidence?

A strong final recommendation should help an internal sales team decide what to do next without overstating the opportunity.

Part H. Optional: Compare your thinking

Review this example only after you have drafted and revised your own recommendation.

There is more than one acceptable way to analyze this customer context. Use this example to compare your reasoning, not to replace your judgment.

Example recommendation

Qualification recommendation: Continue discovery

The customer shows strong early Codex-fit signals, but the opportunity is not ready to progress fully yet.

The pain appears recurring and business-relevant. Modernization delays, review bottlenecks, legacy knowledge gaps, late-stage defects, and inconsistent documentation are affecting roadmap execution and customer-facing priorities.

The likely primary workflow pattern is review and knowledge-transfer friction around legacy services. This appears to affect implementation, review, testing, documentation, and modernization work, but no concrete evaluation task has been selected yet.

Stakeholder engagement is promising. The VP of Engineering, product leadership, engineering managers, platform engineering, and security are all represented. However, ownership and evaluation readiness need more clarity. The customer has not yet agreed on a concrete task, the required context and tools, the target artifact or environment, the verification criteria, or how AI-assisted work would be reviewed and monitored.

Recommended next steps:

- Confirm what repository, test, documentation, or ticket context and which tools would be available.
- Define the target artifact or environment and the checks and human review that would verify the result.
- Confirm which bounded task would create the most useful evidence: reviewing a defined legacy-service change, investigating a specific validation failure, updating tests for a known code path, or updating documentation for a defined change.
- Align with the VP of Engineering and platform engineering on who owns the evaluation.
- Clarify business impact with product leadership, including which roadmap commitments are affected.
- Identify how outputs would be reviewed or validated.
- Involve a technical or security specialist if review, access, or oversight questions become detailed.

This opportunity should continue discovery until the task, owner, required context and tools, target, verification criteria, and readiness assumptions are clear enough to justify deeper Codex discussion.

Compare your draft

As you compare your recommendation with the example, ask:

- Did your recommendation avoid overstating readiness?
- Did your recommendation name the concrete evaluation task, not just the broad modernization problem or workflow pattern?
- Did your next step help the seller gather missing evidence before advancing the opportunity?
- Did your use of GPT critique improve the clarity, evidence, or commercial reasoning in your final recommendation?